

ALISHBA INAM

Cybersecurity Student | SOC Analyst | Blue Team Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity undergraduate at FAST NUCES specializing in Security Operations Center (SOC) operations, Digital Forensics and Incident Response (DFIR), and proactive threat detection. Hands-on experience triaging 50+ daily SIEM alerts using Wazuh and Splunk, correlating events against MITRE ATT&CK TTPs, and analysing endpoint telemetry to identify indicators of compromise (IOCs). Active CTF competitor with national-level placements (2nd at RDX National CTF, 3rd at SudoFuzzers) and author of a hard-level NASCON 2026 Digital Forensics challenge. Complementary experience building secure full-stack applications with hardened authentication, audit logging, and field-level encryption. Pursuing CDSA (Hack The Box) and SOC Analyst Learning Path (Let's Defend) certifications.

EXPERIENCE

SOC Analyst Intern

Tech Hierarchy | February 2026 - March 2026

- Triaged and escalated 50+ daily SIEM alerts using Wazuh and Splunk, applying MITRE ATT&CK framework to classify threats, reduce false-positive noise by 25%, and escalate confirmed incidents per defined SOC runbooks and playbooks.
- Analyzed endpoint telemetry, network logs, and system behavior to identify Indicators of Compromise (IOCs), supporting the full incident response lifecycle from detection through remediation; documented findings in structured reports for Tier 2 handoff.
- Designed and configured SOC lab environments simulating real-world attack scenarios (lateral movement, privilege escalation, persistence mechanisms), validating EDR/IDS detection rules and improving incident response workflows.

Digital Forensics Challenge Creator - NASCON 2026

FAST NUCES Islamabad | 2026

- Designed a hard-level forensic CTF challenge involving a compromised Windows 10 disk image, malicious macro-enabled Word document, PowerShell payloads, NTFS alternate data streams, and multiple persistence mechanisms - completed by fewer than 10% of participants.

Teaching Assistant

FAST NUCES Islamabad | January 2026 - Present

- Supported course delivery by assisting students and helping maintain an effective classroom workflow.
- Prepared documentation and supported assignment review, feedback, and coordination with the instructor to keep academic tasks organized.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Cyber Security

FAST National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences, Islamabad | 2024 - 2028

- Relevant Coursework: Cybersecurity-I, Computer Networks, Software Engineering

Cyber Space Legion | University Cybersecurity Society

- Head of Finance (2025 - Present): Led finance team for flagship cybersecurity events, managed sponsor relations, negotiated with company representatives, and oversaw budgeting and financial reporting.
- Technical Team Member: Participated in national and local CTF competitions, authored forensics and OSINT challenges for society-hosted events and delivered technical workshops to junior members.

Intermediate (FSc / ICS)

Punjab College, Quaid Campus, Rawalpindi | 2022 - 2024

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations: SOC Operations, Alert Triage, Incident Response, DFIR, Threat Detection, Threat Hunting, Log Analysis, IOC Analysis, MITRE ATT&CK, Playbook Execution, Escalation Procedures

SIEM and Security Tools: Wazuh, Splunk, Elastic Stack, Wireshark, Helmet.js, reCAPTCHA, Linux, Docker, Git

Security Concepts: EDR, IDS/IPS, Network Security, Digital Forensics, RBAC, JWT Authentication, CSRF Protection, Rate

Limiting, NoSQL Injection Prevention, Field-Level Encryption, Audit Logging

Programming Languages: Python, C++, JavaScript, x86 Assembly, Bash

Networking: TCP/IP, OSPF, EIGRP, RIPv2, VLSM, NAT, ACLs, DHCP, DNS

Web and Dev Tools: React, Node.js, Express.js, MongoDB, Tailwind CSS, HTML, CSS

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Defensive Security Analyst (CDSA) | Hack The Box (In Progress)
- SOC Analyst Learning Path | Let's Defend (In Progress)
- SOC Fundamentals | Let's Defend (2026)
- Security Operations Center (SOC) | Cisco (2025)
- Network Security | Cisco (2025)
- Ethical Hacking Fundamentals | LearnKartS (2025)
- ISO/IEC 27001 Information Security Associate | SkillFront (2025)
- Windows Forensics with Belkasoft | Belkasoft (2025)
- Advanced Digital Forensics Techniques | Belkasoft (2025)
- Microsoft PowerPoint Certified | Microsoft
- Microsoft Word Certified | Microsoft

PROJECTS

NextGen Residency - Smart Housing Platform | *React, Node.js, Express.js, MongoDB*

- Implemented hardened backend API with Helmet.js security headers, CSRF protection, rate limiting with progressive delays, and NoSQL injection prevention via input sanitization.
- Integrated Two-Factor Authentication (TOTP) with backup codes, Google reCAPTCHA v2, and bcrypt password hashing for multi-layered auth security.
- Implemented audit logging, field-level encryption, and security event monitoring for compliance-grade data protection and incident traceability.

Enterprise Multi-Area Network | *Cisco Packet Tracer, OSPF, EIGRP, RIPv2*

- Engineered enterprise-grade multi-area network topology with 11 LANs, 22 WAN links across 19 routers, implementing mutual route redistribution.
- Secured traffic with Static NAT for public IP translation and Extended ACLs enforcing strict host and subnet-level security policies.
- Designed VLSM addressing scheme for 1M+ hosts; configured DHCP relay agents, DNS, and SMTP/POP3 email servers.

Cybersecurity Portfolio Website | *HTML, CSS, JavaScript*

- Designed a professional cybersecurity-themed portfolio showcasing SOC skills, certifications, and hands-on security experience.

Dizzy Walk - Maze Adventure Game | *x86 Assembly (MASM32), Win32 API*

- Developed real-time graphical game in 2,700+ lines of x86 Assembly with custom data structures and low-level memory management.

SecureShop | *C++, File I/O*

- Constructed a secure shopping platform with user authentication, input validation, and secure data handling; created modular architecture supporting scalable inventory management.

OSIM - Organizational Simulation System | *C++, OOP*

- Built enterprise-style simulation demonstrating OOP principles with robust file handling for persistent data storage of organizational records.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND COMPETITIONS

2nd Place - RDX National CTF | 2025

- Secured 2nd place in a national-level Capture The Flag competition, demonstrating strong forensics, OSINT, and network analysis skills under time-constrained conditions.

3rd Place - SudoFuzzers CTF (Forensics and OSINT) | 2025

- Ranked 3rd out of 50+ teams solving complex digital forensics and OSINT challenges under a 4-hour time constraint, placing in the top 6% of all participants.

7th Place - CyberFest 2025 (National CTF) | 2025

- Achieved top-tier ranking among 100+ competing teams in a highly competitive national CTF event, finishing in the top 7% across forensics, OSINT, and network analysis.